Pyung Kim

Postdoctoral Scholar

Center for Spatial Studies and Data Science
Department of Geography
University of California, Santa Barbara
(Ellison Hall, Office 5841)

pyungkim@ucsb.edu | https://pyungkim.github.io | Google Scholar

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Postdoctoral Scholar 2026 – Present
Center for Spatial Studies and Data Science, Department of Geography, University of California, Santa Barbara

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Research Affiliate 2024 – 2025
Spatial Health AI Research Partnership (SHARP), The University of Texas at Dallas

Instructor 2023 – 2025
Korea Social Science Data Archive (KOSSDA), Seoul National University

Research Assistant 2020
Korea Institute of Public Administration (KIPA)

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Public Policy and Political Economy 2025
The University of Texas at Dallas (Brian J.L. Berry Scholarship, Highest Honor)
Dissertation: *Long-Term Effects of Neighborhoods on Educational Attainment by Disability Status*

M.S. in Geospatial Information Science 2025
The University of Texas at Dallas

M.A. in Public Administration 2020
Yonsei University (Brain Korea 21 PLUS Scholarship, National Research Foundation)

B.A. in Public Administration 2018
Ajou University (National Excellence Scholarship, Deputy Prime Minister of Korea)
Julius-Maximilian University of Würzburg, Germany (Exchange Student, 2016 – 2017)

RESEARCH AREAS

Substantive Health Policy, Social Policy, Urban Policy, Environmental Policy, Disability
Methodological GIS, Spatial Data Science, Causal Inference, Quasi-experiment, Machine Learning

PUBLICATIONS *[*] Corresponding author, [†] Student co-author*

5. **Kim, P.**, Choi, S.[†], Kim, D., & Lee, C[*]. (2026). Bayesian spatio-temporal modeling for policy evaluation: Sensitivity of policy effect estimates in the context of COVID-19 stay-at-home orders. *PLoS One, 21(2): e0339196.*

4. **Kim, P.** [*]**,** Kim D., Scotch R., Jeong D.[†], & Kowalske K. (2025). Geospatial analysis of community-level social and environmental barriers for adult burn injury survivors in North Texas. *Burns*, 51(5), 107512.

3. Hong, S.[*], Jeong, D.[†], & **Kim, P.** (2024). Have offender demographics changed since the COVID-19 Pandemic? Evidence from money mules in South Korea**.** *Journal of Criminal Justice*, 91, 102156.

2. Maxwell, S. P., Brooks, C., **Kim, P.**, Kim, D., McNeely, C. L., & Thomas, K[*]. (2023). Understanding habitats and environmental conditions of white-tailed deer population density and public health data to aid in assessing human tick-borne disease risk. *Microorganisms*, 11(4), 865.

1. **Kim, P.** & Bae, H.[*] (2022). Do firms respond differently to the carbon pricing by industrial sector? How and why? A comparison between manufacturing and electricity generation sectors using firm-level panel data in Korea. *Energy Policy*, 162, 112773.

UNDER REVIEW

Kim, P. [*] "From Command-and-Control to Carbon Pricing: Estimating the Causal Effects on Firm Environmental Performance" (Preprint available at SSRN)

Kim, P., Jung, J. [†], Min, C., Choi, H., Kim., D, Kumar, P. [†], Hwang, J., & Song, D[*]. "mHealth Intervention Integrating Personal PM2.5 Monitoring and Deep Learning to Reduce Pediatric Asthma Exacerbations: A Pilot Study" (Preprint available at JMIR)

Kim, P. [*] "Do Neighborhoods Matter More for Children with Disabilities? Evidence from Texas"

Kim, H.[†], **Kim, P.**[*], "Modeling Policy Diffusion Across Space and Time: A Bayesian Spatial–Temporal Approach"

WORKING PAPERS

"Geospatial Analysis on Dental Health Service Access and Workforce Distribution in Kenya" (with Brenda Okumu, Caroline Kibosia, Dohyeong Kim, Arthur Kemoli, Osman Adullahi, & Hyewon Lee)

"The Impact of Medicaid Expansion on Cancer Outcomes: Evidence on the Moderating Role of Oncology Care Access" (with Kristine Hahm)

"Administrative Deserts in the U.S. Social Security: Field Office Accessibility and SSI Participation" (with Peter Kedron)

"When Does Moving Matter? Residential Relocation and Academic Outcomes Among Children" (with Peter Kedron)

EXTERNAL GRANTS *Non-U.S. awards are reported in USD using award-date exchange rates.*

I have participated in awarded grants totaling $3,717,126, of which my recognized contribution was $32,800.

[PI / Co-PI]

1. What Is the Relationship Between Adolescent Neighborhood Environments and Long-Run Labor Market Outcomes for Children with Disabilities? 2024 – 2025
   - **PI: Pyung Kim**, UTD
   - *Social Security Administration via Retirement and Disability Research Center at UW-Madison* ($6,000; Recognition: $6,000)

[Key Personnel]

4. Interventional Study to Prevent Exacerbation of Atopic Dermatitis by Exposure to Particulate Matter 2024 – 2027
   - Role: Data Scientist
   - PI: Kangmo Ahn, *Samsung Medical Center*
   - *Korea Disease Control and Prevention Agency* ($629,630; Recognition: $4,600)

3. Geospatial Community Mapping to Assess Social and Environmental Barriers and Facilitators for Burn Survivors 2022 – 2026
   - Role: GIS Specialist
   - PI: Karen Kowalske, *UTSW Medical Center*; co-PI: Dohyeong Kim & Richard Scotch, *UTD*
   - *National Institute on Disability, Independent Living, and Rehabilitation Research* ($2,320,495; Recognition: $12,600)

2. The Capacity-Building Project for Primary Healthcare Workforce to Improve Maternal and Child Oral Health in Kilifi County, Kenya 2025 – 2026
   - Role: GIS Specialist **(field study in Kenya, October 2025)**
   - PI: Hyewon Lee, *Seoul National University*
   - *Korea International Cooperation Agency* ($440,000; Recognition: $5,600)

1. Spatial Distribution of Natural Radiation in Jeonbuk and Jeonnam Provinces 2023 – 2025
   - Role: GIS Specialist
   - PI: Yeol Rho, *Chonnam National Univ.*; co-PI: Dohyeong Kim, *UTD*
   - *National Institute of Environmental Research of Korea* ($320,000; Recognition: $4,000)

AWARDS AND HONORS

[External Awards]

Public Administration Research Conference Travel Award, *University of Central Florida* 2025

Junior Scholar Intensive Training (JSIT), *Social Security Administration via UW-Madison* 2024

President Travel Award for APPAM, *Korean Association for Policy Studies* 2023

Brain Korea 21 PLUS Scholarship, *National Research Foundation* 2018 – 2020

The Next Century Humanities Scholarship (National Excellence Scholarship), 2015 – 2018
awarded by the Deputy Prime Minister; funded by the Korea Student Aid Foundation

[Internal Awards]

GIS Pioneer Research Scholarship, *UT Dallas & Pioneer Natural Resources*	2025
Keith Lankford Taylor Fellowship, *UT Dallas*	2023
Brian J.L. Berry Scholarship (Highest Honor), *UT Dallas*	2021 – 2025
UT Dallas Graduate Studies Scholarship, *UT Dalla*	2021 – 2025
YUPA Graduate Studies Scholarship, *Yonsei University*	2018 – 2020
President's Award for Outstanding Graduate, *Ajou University*	2018
Teaching Assistantship for Undergraduate Student, *Ajou University*	2015 – 2018
Excellence in Undergraduate Research Project, *Ajou University*	2015
Merit-based Full Tuition Scholarship, *Ajou University*	2014
Dean's list, *Ajou University*	2014; 2015

MEDIA APPEARANCES

UT Dallas News. (2026). *How Communities Shape Burn Survivors' Return to Society*. https://news.utdallas.edu/social-sciences/burn-survivors-societal-reentry-2026/

INVITED TALKS

"Long-Term Effects of Neighborhoods on Educational Attainment by Disability Status", *Geography Colloquium, University of California, Santa Barbara* — May 2026 (planned)

"Using GIS to Improve Rural Health Service Planning: Lessons from Kilifi County, Kenya", *Kilifi Department of Health in Kilifi County, Kenya* — Oct 2025

TEACHING

[Co-Instructor]

Machine Learning and Deep Learning for Social Science (with R) — Winter 2026
- *Korea Social Science Data Archive* (graduate)
- *Rating: 9.64/10*

GIS and Spatial Statistics (with QGIS, GeoDa, and R) — Summer 2025
- *Korea Social Science Data Archive* (graduate)
- *Rating: 9.91/10*

Advanced GIS and Spatial Statistics (with R) — Summer 2023
- *Korea Social Science Data Archive* (graduate)
- *Rating: 9.84/10*

Introductory GIS and Spatial Statistics (with QGIS, GeoDa, and STATA) — Summer 2023
- *Korea Social Science Data Archive* (graduate)
- *Rating: 9.54/10*

[Guest Lecture]

- Quasi-Experimental Mover Designs, Geography and Policy Lab, *UC Santa Barbara* Feb 2026
- Analysis of Variance, undergraduate statistics course (EPPS 2302), *UT Dallas* April 2025
- Probability Distributions, undergraduate statistics course (EPPS 2302), *UT Dallas* Feb 2025
- Introductory Calculus, graduate statistics course (EPPS 7313), *UT Dallas* Sep 2023

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

* APPAM (Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management); APHA (American Public Health Association); ASPA (American Society for Public Administration); ACRM (American Congress of Rehabilitation Medicine); SER (Society for Epidemiologic Research); ASA (American Sociological Association)

2025 APPAM, APHA, ASA, SER
2024 APPAM, ACRM, ASPA
2023 APPAM, APHA, ASPA

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Statistical Analysis (R, STATA)
Geospatial Analysis (R, Arc GIS, QGIS, GeoDa, Tableau)
Machine Learning / Deep Learning (R)

RESTRICTED DATA ACCESS

2. The Impacts of School Neighborhoods on the Academic and Labor Market Outcomes of Students with Disabilities 2024
   - *PI:* ***Pyung Kim***
   - *Student-level longitudinal data (1999 – 2023, N $\geq$ 5,000,000)*
   - *Source: Texas Schools Project*

1. Geospatial Community Mapping to Assess Social and Environmental Barriers and Facilitators for Burn Survivors 2022
   - *PI: Karen Kowalske, UTSW Medical Center, UTD*
   - *Patient-level longitudinal data (1994 – 2022, N $\geq$ 25,000)*
   - *Source: National Institute on Disability, Independent Living, and Rehabilitation Research*

SERVICE

[Editorial Board Member]
Journal of Safety and Crisis Management 2026 – Present

[Conference Reviewer]
2026 APPAM Annual Fall Research Conference

[Peer Reviewer]
Policy Studies Journal; Scientific Reports; Energy Policy; Energy Economics; International Journal of Finance and Economics; PLOS ONE

[University Service]

Secretary, *Korean Student Association, UT Dallas*	2023 – 2024
Vice President, *Graduate Student Assembly in Public Administration, Yonsei University*	2018 – 2019
Student Mentor, *Office of Admissions, Ajou University*	2014 – 2015